Local Search, SEO, GBP, AEO & GEO Audit — Technical

Target: Ali's C Store · 1048 Kern St, Taft, CA 93268
Audit date: September 2026 · **Version:** reviewed and corrected

Executive summary

- **Scope:** tobacco / vape / convenience retail at one location in Taft, CA.
- **Primary finding:** no owned website was found, and no evidence of owner-managed Google Business Profile (GBP) activity. Visibility currently depends on third-party directory listings (SmokeShops.com, Shisha.com) the owner does not control.
- **Positive signal:** the reviews that do exist are strong (5.0 rating across 6 reviews on Shisha.com).
- **Main competitor gap:** Fred's Cigarette Store (1006 6th St, ~0.64 mi) shows 85+ reviews and listed hours on the same directory.

> **P0:** Locate the existing Google Maps listing for 1048 Kern St (Google often auto-creates one). Claim it with the owner present, or create it if none exists. Then set categories and verified hours, and add real storefront and interior photos.

Reviewer notes: verify before presenting

1. **GBP status was not checked on Google directly.** Every source is a third-party directory. Before the meeting, search Google Maps for "Ali's C Store Taft" and record whether a listing exists, whether it shows "Own this business?", its review count, rating, hours, and photos. Update Section 3 with those numbers.
2. **The review counts are directory reviews, not Google reviews.** "6 vs 85" comes from Shisha.com and compares the two shops on the same site, which is fair, but do not present it as a Google review count.
3. **G&A Mini-Mart and Speed Stop** are listed as competitors without a source in the evidence log. Verify them, or drop them.
4. **The scores are heuristic.** The category scores and weights are judgment calls, not a standard measurement. The weighted total (19.25) is arithmetically correct. The priority-score formula is undocumented: for example, 90 / 82.75 / 85 does not average to 85.58. Use the scores for ranking only, and avoid showing decimal precision to the client.
5. **Overpromises removed.** The original claimed "will yield immediate map pack visibility" and "will capture voice search answers." Neither can be guaranteed. Map-pack placement depends on proximity, relevance, prominence, and Google's systems.
6. **Domain choice.** The original suggested `aliscstoretaft.com`, while the proposal pricing lists `aliscstore.com`. Check availability of both and pick one before quoting.
7. **California compliance.** California restricts retail sale of most flavored tobacco and vape products, and the minimum sale age is 21. Website and GBP product copy must not advertise restricted products. Have the owner confirm what he legally sells before writing product content.

1. Business input & status

Field	Value / status	Verification	Evidence
Business name	Ali's C Store	V3	E3
Website	None found	N3	E3
Address	1048 Kern St, Taft, CA 93268	V3	E3
Primary category	Tobacco shop / convenience store	V3	E3
Products (per directory)	Cigarettes, vapes, tobacco, glass pipes, accessories. Confirm against CA rules.	V3	E3
Hours	Not listed. Get them from the owner.	N2	E2
Service area	Taft, West Kern County	V2	E2
Competitors	Fred's Cigarette Store (sourced); G&A Mini-Mart, Speed Stop (unsourced)	V3 / V1	E3 / E1
GBP status	**Not checked on Google.** Check before the meeting.	—	—

2. Scorecard (heuristic)

Category	Score	Weight	Weighted	Coverage	Confidence	Status
Google Business Profile	38	25%	9.50	75%	75	Provisional
Traditional SEO	0	25%	0.00	100%	90	Confirmed (no site)
Local SEO	30	20%	6.00	65%	70	Provisional
AEO	15	15%	2.25	50%	60	Provisional
GEO	10	15%	1.50	50%	60	Provisional
Total			**19.25 / 100**	68%	71	Major gaps

The "Commercial Opportunity" (72.5) and "Growth Opportunity Index" (75.5) scores from the original draft are omitted because their method is undocumented.

3. Competitor gap

Factor	Ali's C Store	Fred's Cigarette Store	Target
Location	1048 Kern St	1006 6th St (~0.64 mi)	—
Directory reviews (Shisha.com)	6 (5.0 avg)	85+	30+ Google reviews in 6 months
Google reviews	*Check on Maps*	*Check on Maps*	—
Hours listed	No	Yes (7 AM – 11 PM)	Verified hours on GBP and site
Owned website	No	No (directory only)	Mobile site with NAP, products, map

Fred's also appears to have no owned website. A well-built site plus a complete GBP would put Ali's ahead on that factor.

4. Priority matrix

Priority	Opportunity	Category	Action	Package
P0	Claim & complete GBP	GBP	Claim or create the listing; set the primary category (Tobacco shop) and secondary categories (Convenience store, Vape shop, if accurate); add hours, phone, and 15+ real photos.	Get Found (basic) / Get Chosen (full)
P1	Owned mobile website	Trad. SEO	Fast site with NAP, hours, product categories, directions, FAQ, and age notice.	Get Found +
P1	Structured data	AEO / GEO	JSON-LD for `Store`/`LocalBusiness` (NAP, geo, hours) and `FAQPage`. Improves machine readability; does not guarantee AI or voice answers.	Get Found +
P1	In-store review system	Local SEO	QR counter card linking to the GBP review form. Ask every customer; no incentives and no filtering, per Google policy.	Get Chosen
P2	Citation sync	Local SEO	Consistent NAP on Apple Business Connect, Bing Places, Yelp, and the main directories; correct SmokeShops.com and Shisha.com.	Get Chosen
P2	Ongoing GBP activity	GBP	2 posts per month, photo updates, review responses, and a monthly report.	Get Chosen care plan

5. Timeline (aligned to package delivery)

Window	Work
Week 1	Agreement signed. GBP claim/verification started (owner present; video or postcard verification). Photos taken. Hours, products, and compliance confirmed.
Weeks 2–3	Website built on the domain; JSON-LD added; GBP completed; review card printed and placed.
Weeks 3–4	Launch. Citation sync on Apple, Bing, Yelp, and directories. Owner walkthrough.
Months 2–3	Monthly GBP posts, review responses, and a monthly report (calls, direction requests, site visits, reviews). Compare against the baseline recorded before launch.

> **Baseline to record before launch** (so later reports show real change): Google review count and rating, GBP views, calls, and direction requests if the profile already exists, plus a screenshot of the "smoke shop Taft" results on Maps.

6. Evidence log

Finding	Source	Verif.	Evid.	Notes
Name & address	SmokeShops.com	V3	E3	1048 Kern St, Taft, CA 93268
Product categories	SmokeShops.com	V3	E3	Tobacco, vapes, glass pipes, cigarettes
Reviews	Shisha.com	V3	E3	5.0 across 6 reviews
Competitor	Shisha.com	V3	E3	Fred's Cigarette Store, 85 reviews
Website	Web search	N3	E3	No owned domain found
GBP	—	—	—	**Not yet checked on Google Maps**